FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-32-17019

Issue Title : Landing Gear Overhaul Intervals

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3200-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
757, 747, 767, 737NG, 777, 737	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/11/2017	05/11/2017	04/19/2017

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Description

Main Landing Gear overhaul is required in accordance with the MPD task 32-040-01/-02 at 21,000 cycles or 10 years whichever occurs first.

Nose Landing Gear overhaul is required in accordance with MPD task 32-090-00 at 18,000 cycles or 10 years whichever occurs first.

Many operators ask when the Time Between Overhaul (TBO) interval 'clock' starts. This FTD article should help answer many questions about landing gear TBO intervals.

The TBO cycle intervals are set to prevent excessive wear and are based on fleet sampling data, and the actual wear seen at predetermined overhaul intervals.

The TBO calendar intervals are set to minimize corrosion and are based on the proven and tested ability of the protective finishes (cadmium, chromate, primer and enamel paint) to protect the base metal.

Both intervals are independent and equally important.

Cycle accumulation is relatively easy to track as this is equal to the number of aircraft landings. The calendar interval can be more subjective.

As the calendar interval is related to the onset/development of corrosion, any exposure to an environment that can promote corrosion means that calendar time will accumulate. Therefore an installed component/gear assembly will accumulate calendar time after delivery/installation. If a component/gear assembly is not installed, but stored in a way where it is not exposed to the environment, the onset of corrosion is delayed until that part is exposed to the environment i.e. removed from storage, and therefore properly stored parts do not accumulate calendar time.

Background

For newly delivered aircraft, the Landing Gear TBO clock starts at the aircraft delivery date. This assumes the time that passes between aircraft assembly (roll-out) and delivery to the customer is 'standard' and that there are no extended periods of storage prior to aircraft delivery. Delays to aircraft delivery after factory roll-out may affect the start of the calendar TBO interval in an

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operators' maintenance program. This is accounted for in the 737-BBJ maintenance program due to the time spent at the aircraft customization center.

For a newly overhauled landing gear assembly, the time between completion of overhaul and installation on an aircraft is typically relatively short (days or weeks, not months) therefore the calendar TBO clock can be assumed to start at either the date on the overhaul release certificate OR the date of installation on the aircraft (usually the latter). If the time between completion of overhaul and installation is prolonged (e.g. a month or more) then the TBO clock should start at the overhaul completion date (date on the release certificate) unless stored correctly as discussed below.

For new spares or overhauled parts/assemblies that are not immediately used/installed on an aircraft, then the start of the TBO clock is dependent on how the parts are stored.

As discussed above, the calendar TBO interval is a function of development of corrosion. If a new or overhauled part is stored in a way that does not promote corrosion i.e. properly protected, wrapped, or in an environmentally controlled facility, then the TBO clock will start when the part is removed from spares/storage and subsequently exposed to the environment. If a part is not properly protected/stored then the TBO clock will start on the date of certification of that part and calendar time will be consumed during storage as there is no protection from corrosion.

Proper storage and handling of a landing gear when removed from the aircraft and put in storage can slow the effect of protective finishes degrading/corrosion progressing. However it is not possible to completely eliminate that progression and "stop the clock" without overhaul. Therefore, obtaining credit for storage time against the TBO once a landing gear has been placed in service with parts exposed to the environment cannot generally be done.

If an operators' TBO interval does not adequately control corrosion, then is may be necessary to reduce the TBO calendar interval to correct corrosion early, or adjust the maintenance program to help delay the onset of corrosion.

Standard Overhaul Practices Manual (SOPM) 20-44-02 and SOPM 20-70-01 both discuss storage and protection of parts. 737CL CMM 32-11-11 discusses shock strut storage in section 701 (Assembly) and can be used as a guide to storing any landing gear shock strut. It is important to protect the internal parts of the shock strut by using preservative hydraulic fluid as well as protecting the external exposed surfaces.

Note: Any assumptions made to determine a maintenance plan (i.e. TBO start date) should be approved by an operators regulatory authority as part of the maintenance program.

Status

Not Applicable

Interim Action

None

Final Action

If properly stored and protected from environemental effects, new or overhauled landing gear components/assemblies do not accumulate calendar time (TBO) while in storage.

Operator Action

None

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Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Maintenance Planning Document (MPD)	D626A001		
Maintenance Planning Document (MPD)	D626A001-BBJ		
Component Maintenance Manual (CMM)	32-11-11		
Overhaul Manual (OHM)	20-44-02		
Overhaul Manual (OHM)	20-70-01		
Fleet Team Economic (FTE)	FTE-05-10002		

Related Categories

- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability
- Fleet Team IdeaXchange : Topic of discussion on the Fleet Team IdeaXchange bulletin board

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